Valerii Kliuchnikov

Senior Software Engineer

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Profile

Senior Software Engineer (Go) with 9 years shipping production backend systems across fintech, AI tooling, and social platforms. Currently at Playneta's Kiss 2.0 social platform (22K DAU, $2.4M ARR run-rate) — in the first 6 months shipped three production services (LLM chat translation at ∼9.6M messages/mo and 0.3% of product revenue, rule-based UGC moderation, and a monorepo-wide DLQ layer) and contributed across 22 of 28 monorepo services. Previously delivered enterprise RBAC and payment systems at 2M+ daily transactions, 10K+ checks/sec, and zero-downtime migrations for 1M+ users. Hands-on tech lead: 30+ technical interviews conducted and 3 engineers mentored. Based in Barcelona; after 7 years of full-time senior roles, spent 2025–2026 on B2B contract engagements via Spanish autónomo setup during relocation. Now returning to a long-term full-time backend engineering role with EU or North American companies.

Technical Skills

Languages:	Go, SQL, Python, JavaScript
Backend:	Microservices, REST, gRPC, Protobuf, Gin, Echo, chi, GORM, Wire DI, DDD
Data:	PostgreSQL, ScyllaDB, Cassandra, Redis
Messaging:	Kafka, Redpanda, RabbitMQ, asynq
AI/LLM:	MCP, OpenRouter, multi-model routing, Agno, Claude Code
Cloud/DevOps:	GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub), Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Terraform, GitLab CI, Jenkins
Observability:	Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Security:	OAuth 2.0, JWT, RBAC
Compliance:	GDPR, PCI DSS
Testing:	Table-driven, testify, integration, k6

Professional Experience

May 2026 – Present — **Senior Software Engineer**, *B2B Contract, Playneta Limited*, Nicosia, Cyprus, Remote

- Contributing engineer on Kiss 2.0 social platform (**22K DAU, $2.4M ARR run-rate**): 30 Go microservices across Redpanda (360 topics, 52 consumer groups) and multi-region infra on DigitalOcean + Yandex Cloud; authored **310 commits across 22 of 28 monorepo services**; main author of translation and moderation services, major contributor to shared library (DLQ, moderation & translation clients)
- Designed and shipped a real-time LLM chat translation service in Go: **∼9.6M messages/mo at 612ms median / 981ms p95 end-to-end**; auto-detection across 26 source languages, targets selected dynamically from conversation roster; two-stage pipeline (Kafka consumer → asynq worker) hardened against hallucinations, truncation and concurrent updates
- Cost-optimised two-model LLM routing via OpenRouter (Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite primary, GPT-4.1 Nano fallback) with per-model circuit breaker and Redis cross-message cache at **25% hit rate**, keeping total LLM spend at **∼$591/month (∼$61 per 1M messages, ∼$7K/year — 0.3% of platform revenue)**; full per-translation provenance (model, tokens, cost, latency) in Cassandra and Kafka events
- Translation infra reliability: stage-2 LLM worker processes **5.1M tasks/week at 99.995% success**; HTTP API serves **34M requests/24 days at 99.998% success**, p99 read 183ms; Helm-based Kubernetes with HPA across API, shared-consumer and worker pools

- Built a platform-wide UGC moderation service from scratch using strict DDD layering (Postgres + ScyllaDB + Redis, Wire DI); rule-based engine (Aho-Corasick dictionary + regex for contacts/links) covering nicknames, bio, club name/status and chat messages across 5 content types; bulk dictionary API with versioning, per-field rejection codes and a userId-scoped check endpoint
- Moderation serves ∼**99K checks/day at p99 = 10ms — 10x under the client fail-open deadline — with zero errors in 24 days**; integrated into user, chat and clubs so all text UGC and anti-spam routes through a single moderation path
- Designed a reusable DLQ layer for Redpanda consumers in the shared go-kiss2 library; adopted by **4 services (chat, clubs, translation, migration)**, capturing ∼**1.8K failed messages/day at a 0.016% failure rate (∼1 in 6,100 consumed events)** into a single versioned dlq topic for later triage
- DLQ phase 1 (produce-only, at-most-once with 3 in-process retries) in production; phase 2 (at-least-once semantics with per-group self-replay, configurable ReplayDelay/MaxReplays, dlq.parked for exhausted messages, opt-in Permanent error marker) designed and implemented, pending main merge

September 2025 – April 2026 **Software Engineer**, *B2B Contract, Refact.ai*, London, UK, Remote

- Architected and delivered 10+ MCP server integrations and third-party connectors from scratch, expanding the platform's tool ecosystem autonomously in a fully async remote setup
- Designed a declarative MCP preset system that streamlined user onboarding and reduced configuration overhead for new integrations
- Built in-chat MCP configuration flow via chatbot interface, enabling users to connect and configure external tools without leaving the conversation context
- Implemented an OAuth 2.0 and token-based authorization framework for secure authentication across external system integrations

May 2024 – July 2025 **Senior Software Engineer**, *Confidential Fintech Platform (under NDA)*, Remote

- Designed and delivered a Go-based RBAC platform (PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka) serving 1M+ enterprise users under financial-regulator compliance; zero-downtime migration completed in 4 months, lifting permission-assignment success rate by 50%
- Built an automated data-sync pipeline in Go for 200K legal entities using event-driven architecture (Kafka + gRPC), cutting manual data updates by 60% and reducing staleness by 75%
- Architected a high-throughput notification service (Go, Kafka, PostgreSQL) processing 1M+ alerts/day at 99.9% uptime across multiple consumer groups
- Extended RBAC with real-time transaction-limit enforcement — 10K+ checks/sec over 1M active accounts — reducing limit-breach errors by 90%; designed for horizontal scaling on Kubernetes
- Conducted 30+ technical interviews, defined hiring rubrics, and mentored 3 engineers through structured onboarding, cutting ramp-up time by 40%

May 2022 – May 2024 **Software Engineer**, *Quadcode*, Larnaca, Cyprus, Hybrid

- Owned Go payment services layer (Redis, PostgreSQL, Kafka) processing up to 1M transactions/day across multiple crypto and fiat providers; optimised concurrency patterns cutting server load by 40% and reducing pipeline maintenance costs by 70%
- Prototyped an advanced Crypto Payment Provider integration, securing executive approval and rolling it out to three teams
- Designed a declarative integration framework that reduced new payment-provider onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 week
- Rebuilt GitLab CI with precommit hooks, accelerating pipelines by 20% and reducing review cycles by 90%
- Delivered GDPR-compliant anonymization and PCI DSS tokenization services from scratch

Mar 2020 – May 2022 **Software Engineer**, *ProCSy*, Moscow, Russia, Remote

- Built 10+ Hyperledger Fabric smart contracts, automating workflows and reducing manual reconciliation by 70%
- Established an SMTP mailing system handling 10K+ daily emails at 98% delivery rate
- Decomposed a monolithic application into 6 microservices, cutting deployment time from 30 to 5 minutes
- Automated CI pipelines with GitLab CI and golangci-lint, achieving 90% reduction in feedback cycles

Jan 2018 – Mar 2020 **Junior Software Engineer**, *ITMO University*, Saint Petersburg, Russia, Hybrid

- Developed a modular resource-visualization system (Go, OOP) and a GORM-based relational schema for an internal simulation platform used in research courseware

Projects

Personal AI PM — Agentic personal project manager that plans, tracks and drives my work and life tasks across inbox, calendar and todo surfaces; built end-to-end through AI-paired development with Claude Code.

ESP32 ecosystem — Hands-on embedded hobby: DIY portable cyberdeck ("Decker") and a self-hosted smart home, both on ESP32 microcontrollers with custom firmware and local-first automation.

Education

Sep 2015 – Jun 2019 **Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering**, *ITMO University*, Saint Petersburg, Russia
Faculty of Software Engineering and Computer Systems

Additional Information

Languages — Russian — Native, English — Professional working proficiency

Interests — 3D printing, RC aircraft, microelectronics